

# Übersicht

## Give a new look to your MacBook's home screen

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If you are familiar with computer systems and the debates and discussions that surround them, you may be well versed with the fact that Apple is stringent with their policy of letting users customise their products. With the recent MacBooks, the hardware customisation is completely gone, but there's the software that still remains to be tinkered with. This can be done using one of the few tools that are out there in the wild. One such tool is Übersicht.

Übersicht is a tool that runs on MacOS, helping users customise their desktop with some cool and extremely useful widgets that are written in JavaScript and HTML 5. Developed in Germany, Übersicht is known for being a user friendly tool. Moreover, if you can code in the required languages, you can create your own widget.

MacOS is notoriously difficult to customise, unlike a Linux distro. In the case of MacOS, both the hardware (the MacBooks) and the software is made by Apple, which makes it work great, but there are constraints that come along with it. Übersicht solves that problem. We are here to introduce you to this tool and get you the information that you need to make your MacBook home screen personalised.

### GET IT ONTO YOUR MACHINE

Übersicht is not an Apple certified app, so you will need to sideload it onto your MacBook. For that, go on the Übersicht webpage – <https://digit.in/ubersicht>, and hit the download button. Once downloaded, extract the zip file, and open the setup app, which will appear in the same folder where the zip file had

been extracted in. Your Mac will ask for a couple of permissions, and once you grant them, you'll see the tiny Übersicht icon on your toolbar.

Once installed, you will see a widget welcoming you to the world of Übersicht and showing you some of the basic guidelines of how to go about setting up the desktop of your needs.

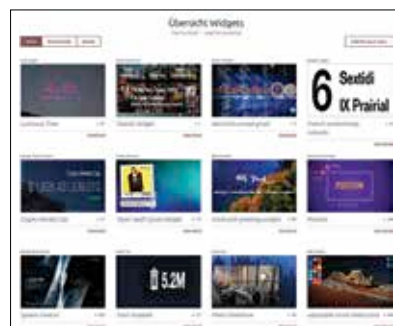
### THE WIDGETS

Once you have Übersicht installed and the example widget is on your screen, the next step is to get some of your own widgets into the system. For that, you have two paths. The first one is through the Übersicht website. When you are on the website, you will see a button right next to the 'Download' button, which says 'Get Widgets'. Click that and you will be sent to the Übersicht Widgets page. The second one is through the taskbar. If you click on the small Übersicht icon in your taskbar, you will get a dropdown menu, which has the clearly labelled option with the text 'Visit Widget Gallery'. If you click this, you will land on the same page like the one we explained earlier.

When you are on this page, you will see a myriad of widgets, which you can pick and choose from according to your liking and need. If you are an Iron Man fan, you can download the 'Ironman

Reactor Widget', or say if you want your system stats listed on your homepage, you can download the 'iStats Widget'. After you have chosen the widget of your choice, go to the download button, and hit download.

The download will get you a zip file, which, once you extract, will yield a folder bearing the name of the widget. Now, head over to the Übersicht icon in your taskbar and hit the button labelled as 'Open Widgets Folder'. This will pop open a folder in a new window. Simply drag and drop or copy and paste the entire folder of the widget which you had extracted earlier over here. As soon as you drop it in there, your widget will appear on your screen. If you are happy with the placement and function of your widget, then well enough, you can stop reading the article here. But if you want to tweak the widget, then stick around.

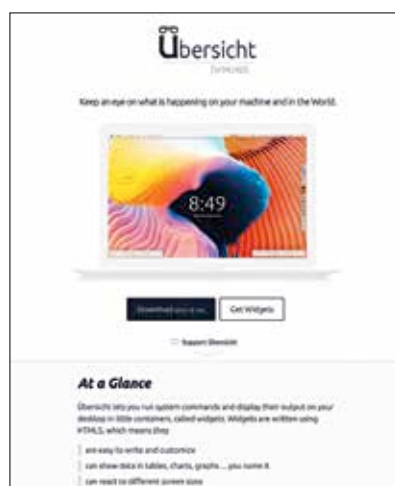


Choose your own poison

### MAKING THE CHANGES

Say you have installed your favourite widget but are not happy with the way it looks, the font or the size and positioning. There are options in Übersicht to tweak the widget. To get started with this process, you will need to head back to the app's widgets folder. In there, navigate to the folder of the widget that you want to customise. In this case, we have the basic calendar widget. Inside that folder, you will need to find the file that contains the code for the widget. A tip for locating these files is that all of the files are with the extension, .coffee. After you have located the file, open it with the text editor of your choice. What we used was the TextEdit app, and we recommend you to do the same, as it will work just fine.

Inside the TextEdit window, you will find a bunch of code written. Do not tinker with anything that you are sure will change things as you want to. Else, you



The Übersicht webpage